

WHERE HAVE ALL THE HEROES GONE?

*** DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE**

**** DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO
TECHNICIAN**

TEXT: [Hebrews 11:1-3](#) (NKJV) *“What is faith? It is the confident assurance that what we hope for is going to happen. It is the evidence of things we cannot yet see. ² God gave his approval to people in days of old because of their faith. ³ By faith we understand that the entire universe was formed at God’s command, that what we now see did not come from anything that can be seen.”* [Hebrews 11:8-19](#) (NKJV) *“It was by faith that Abraham obeyed when God called him to leave home and go to another land that God would give him as his inheritance. He went without knowing where he was going. ⁹ And even when he reached the land God promised him, he lived there by faith—for he was like a foreigner, living in a tent. And so did Isaac and Jacob, to whom God gave the same promise. ¹⁰ Abraham did this because he was confidently looking forward to a city with eternal foundations, a city designed and built by God. ¹¹ It was by faith that Sarah together with Abraham was able to have a child, even though they were too old and Sarah was barren. Abraham believed that God would keep his promise. ¹² And so a whole nation came from this one man, Abraham, who was too old to have any children—a nation with*

so many people that, like the stars of the sky and the sand on the seashore, there is no way to count them.
¹³ *All these faithful ones died without receiving what God had promised them, but they saw it all from a distance and welcomed the promises of God. They agreed that they were no more than foreigners and nomads here on earth."*

INTRO: We live in a world that no doubt has a shortage of worthy heroes. As a result of a lack of Godly heroes [this generation has sought out people with no morals and transformed them into role models:](#)
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- [Michael Jackson](#)
- [Madonna](#)
- [Dennis Rodman](#)
- [Britney Spears](#)

We have substituted celebrities for heroes! Are these the kind of people we would like the next generation to imitate? I don't think so!

There is a vast difference between being a celebrity and being a hero!

It is not easy being a hero. Maybe that is why there are so few of them around today. We should ask ourselves, "*Where have all the heroes gone?*"

Perhaps [one of the greatest needs we have today is to regain a sense of the heroic.](#)

The Bible is full of good, Godly heroes who lived lives of integrity. They were certainly not perfect but they were people with feet of clay that we would do well to follow. [Hebrews eleven gives us a Gallery of Heroes:](#)
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- [Enoch](#) (E-Knock)
- [Noah](#)
- [Abraham](#)
- [Isaac](#)
- [Jacob](#)
- [Joseph](#)
- [Moses](#)
- [Rahab](#) (Ray-Hab)
- [Gideon](#)
- [Barak](#) (Just like Barak Obama – And you thought he was just a Democratic Presidential Nominee!)
- [Samson](#)
- [Jephthah](#) (Jeff-Tuh)
- [David](#)
- [Samuel](#)

This is not a full list; there are many others who are unnamed but not forgotten heroes.

The story of these heroes can be the story of every Dad here today! [God is still in the business of creating heroes.](#) **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

ILLUSTRATION: A young man was listening as the great Boston preacher Phillips Brooks talked of the

great days of the past when the United States was a growing nation. He told about the time when brave explorers traveled into areas that had not been explored. He told of those who risked and sometimes gave their lives as they helped develop the country. The young man heard Bishop Brooks tell of those who gave their lives that others might have liberty to study the Bible and obey God. These stories thrilled this young man and he said to the bishop, *"I wish I had lived in those far-off days; I think I too could have been a hero."* The bishop replied, *"My boy, every age brings its opportunity, and if you cannot be a hero now, you would not have been a hero then."*

God is still in the hero making business! You and I can be heroic if we choose.

What kind of stuff are heroes made of? There are many ingredients of course that go into making a hero but we are going to talk about the three most important ingredients.

I. HEROES ARE PEOPLE OF COURAGE

ILLUSTRATION: Two small boys walked into Dr. Mike Holmes dentist's office and one of them said bravely, *"I want a tooth taken out and I don't want any gas and I don't want it deadened because we're in a hurry!"* Dr. Mike said, *"You're a brave young man. Which tooth is it?"* The boy turned to his smaller friend and said, *"Show him your tooth, Tommy."*

The biggest problem with **courage** is that it **is only apparent in the face of hardship.**

Most of us prefer comfort to courage. Maybe that's why there are few heroes today.

The heroes of the Bible faced a lot of hardship and when they were facing such difficulty, God seems to model tough love: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- When Job complained, God told him, *“Stand up on your feet; I have something to show you.”*
- When Elijah was hiding from Jezebel, God said *“Get up, I have things for you to do.”*
- When Moses was hiding on Jethro's ranch, God said, *“Quit making excuses, I will have someone to talk for you.”*
- When Paul complained about a *“Thorn in the flesh,”* God said, *“Stop griping. My grace will be sufficient.”*

Being a hero is not easy but it is rewarding. One cannot be a hero without courage. Courage is the resource God gives us when we are fighting giants.

If we never go out to fight giants, we have no need for courage. Our giants sometimes take on the following forms: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- A fatal disease
- The loss of a loved one
- The end of a dream or a career
- The test of our ethics or character

Some of the most courageous people I know will never make the front cover of People Magazine, CNN, or FOX News. They are quiet people, modest people. But they stand for what is right, they refuse to let go of their faith in times of great stress; they hang in there when the going gets tough. In their own quiet way, they are heroic. People of great courage are: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Pastors who refuse to compromise.
- Lay members who fill a post of duty faithfully.
- Dads who stand against the enemy for their family. Joshua said, *“As for me and my house, we will serve the Lord.”*

Dads, the enemy is out to destroy your family and tear apart our homes. Will you be a hero?

II. HEROES ARE PEOPLE OF GREAT CHARACTER

Proverbs 22:1 (NKJV) *“A good name is to be chosen rather than great riches.”* Ecclesiastes 7:1 (NKJV) *“A good reputation is more valuable than the most expensive perfume.”*

When the First Century Church was being set in order, character was one of the qualifications of the ministers and deacons: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Ministers – 1 Timothy 3:1-4 (NKJV) *“If a man desires the position of a bishop, he desires a good work. ² A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, temperate, sober-minded, of good behavior, hospitable, able to*

teach; ³not given to wine, not violent, not greedy for money, but gentle, not quarrelsome, not covetous; ⁴one who rules his own house well, having his children in submission with all reverence.”

- Deacons – Acts 6:3 (NKJV) *“Now look around among yourselves, brothers, and select seven men who are well respected and are full of the Holy Spirit and wisdom. We will put them in charge of this business.”*

Character is a quality which seems to be woefully lacking in our society. America has lost its way to a point where:

- More than half of the marriages end in divorce.
- Couples live together without being married.
- Drug and alcohol addiction are destroying a generation of people.
- Politicians are no longer penalized for bad morals.
- Business people raid the resources of their company and then hire high-priced attorneys to help them keep what they have stolen.
- Ministers and church members live like the world rather than living like Jesus.

I have good news and bad news: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The good news is that America has finally reached a point where it is no longer an immoral country.

- The bad news is that America has reached a point where it has NO morals.

Christian Dads must stand against the tide of darkness and become a hero in their own homes by being men of good character.

Let's ask ourselves this question, *"Do we want our children to grow up to live like us?"*

ILLUSTRATION: (A young boy attempting to wear his dad's boots.)

Heroes must be people of good character! The Bible is full of people of such character: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Enoch – *"He had this testimony, he pleased God."*
- Abraham – He was called *"A friend of God."*
- Noah – Was a preacher of righteousness and the Bible said, *"He moved with fear, prepared an Ark to the saving of his house, by which he became an heir of righteousness, which is by faith."*
- Nathaniel – Jesus said, *"Behold an Israelite in whom there is no deceit."*
- The Disciples of Jesus – Judas denied Jesus. The remainder of them lost their lives protecting their character. Only John died a natural death. Yet, he was boiled in oil and left for dead on the Island of Patmos - All this because he refused to cave in to the pressure to compromise.

Because we live in such a loose, immoral, sensual society, it is more important for than ever for Mom and Dad to be people of good character.

If our kids can't look to their cultural idols for appropriate role models, maybe they can look to their parents.

Dad, will you be a man of good character? I encourage you to be a man of integrity so that your children can look to you as a role model.

III. HEROES ARE PEOPLE WHO HAVE PLACED THEIR CONFIDENCE IN GOD

Hebrews 10:35-36 (NKJV) *“Do not throw away this confident trust in the Lord, no matter what happens. Remember the great reward it brings you!”*³⁶ *Patient endurance is what you need now, so you will continue to do God's will. Then you will receive all that he has promised.”*

The amazing thing about the people listed in Hebrews eleven is not how heroic they were, but how human, how ordinary, how very much like us they were:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Noah – Got drunk
- Abraham – Lied
- Isaac – Was in charge of a dysfunctional family
 - His wife aided and abetted her son in deceiving his brother.
- Jacob – Deceived his brother Esau
- Moses – Committed murder – Got mad and broke the Ten Commandments

- **Rahab** – Was a prostitute

These people had some issues, but their courage was not placed in their own abilities. The writer of Hebrews lets us know that these people were the essence of what faith is all about!

Many years ago Mary Lou Redding wrote, *“I’ve grown up in a world of superheroes. Wonder Woman, Superman, Captain Marvel, The Fantastic Four. Ordinary people like me, without super-powers or limbs that stretch for miles or the ability to change form. Well, they can’t be heroes. Or can they? That long list in Hebrews chapter eleven contains a telling phrase: **“They are weak, but became strong.”** It seems that strength and superpowers are not prerequisites to hero-ness. God’s heroes are weak people who have simply made themselves available. Being a hero is not ducking into a phone booth and putting on tights and a flashy costume. It is acknowledging our weakness and limitations and making all that we have available to God.”*

That is how God’s heroes are born. **We have the potential for greatness in us because we have a great God. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERMON)** Greatness is not about us, it is about God! Can we find the confidence to become a hero?

We can all be heroes by faith in Christ. He will give us the courage and the character we need in the time of testing.

CONCLUSION:

The Heroes of faith in Hebrews eleven were not perfect by any stretch of the imagination but they had courage beyond belief.

It is time for weak-willed, pink fingered, tip-toe-through-the-tulip, sissy men to look to God and become infused with the courage of a God who holds the world in His hands; to step forward and become the heroes our children are so desperately searching for.